

- Query/compute layer (Flink/batch jobs)
- Apache Paimon tables (metadata and data files)
- Storage layer (HDFS/S3/GCS)

Key components are table metadata, data files, snapshots, and compaction which maintains performance by merging small files. This architecture allows Paimon to support streaming writes and batch reads efficiently.

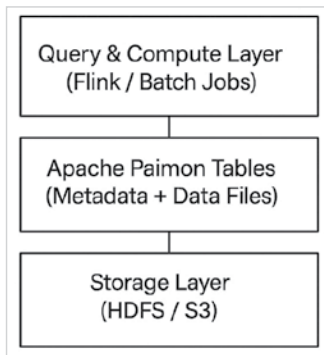


Figure 1: Paimon architecture

Setting up Apache Paimon on Linux

Apache Paimon runs smoothly on Linux and integrates easily with existing big data stacks.

For running Paimon, the prerequisites are:

- Linux-based system (Ubuntu/CentOS)
- Java 8 or later
- Apache Flink (standalone or cluster mode)
- Basic setup steps are:
- Download Apache Flink and Apache Paimon binaries.
- Configure Flink to include the Paimon connector JAR.
- Set up a warehouse directory on HDFS or local file system.

Example configuration in `flink-conf.yaml`:

`table.store.path: file:///data/paimon/warehouse`

```
vikas-ubuntu-vm mkdir -p/data/paimon/warehouse
vikas-ubuntu-vm cd /lib
vikas-ubuntu-vm lib
flink-1.14.4-bin-scala_2.12.tgz
paimon-flink-0.6.1.jar
```

Figure 2: Paimon setup

Basic data operations with Apache Paimon

Apache Paimon tables can be created using SQL via Flink:

```
CREATE TABLE orders (
  order_id BIGINT,
  customer_id BIGINT,
  amount DOUBLE,
  order_time TIMESTAMP(3),
  PRIMARY KEY (order_id) NOT ENFORCED
) WITH (
  'connector' = 'paimon',
  'path' = 'file:///data/paimon/warehouse/orders'
);
```

This creates a primary-key table, allowing updates and deletes.

```
Flink SQL CLI /v1.14.4, 14d1951 @ 2022-01-28
19:58:35, Scala 2.12.15, Java 1.8.0_292, Unix
Driven Flink Interactive JDBC

Flink SQL> CREATE TABLE orders (
  order_id BIGINT,
  customer_id BIGINT,
  amount DOUBLE,
  order_time TIMESTAMPTZ(3),
```

Figure 3: Creating a table with Flink

You can insert data as usual:

```
INSERT INTO orders VALUES
```

```
(1, 101, 250.50, CURRENT_TIMESTAMP), (2, 102, 175.00,
CURRENT_TIMESTAMP);
Updating an existing record is handled automatically
via the primary key:
INSERT INTO orders VALUES (1, 101, 300.00, CURRENT_
TIMESTAMP);
```

Paimon stores this as a change, not a duplicate record.

Common use cases

Real-time analytics:

- Continuous ingestion from Kafka
- Up-to-date dashboards with minimal latency

Streaming pipelines:

- CDC ingestion from transactional databases
- Unified streaming + batch processing

AI and ML-ready data:

- Incremental feature computation
- Consistent, versioned datasets for training and inference

Apache Paimon's snapshot and incremental-read capabilities make it especially useful for modern AI pipelines. Its open source nature, strong integration with Apache Flink, and support for upserts and incremental processing position it as a powerful choice for modern data platforms. As organisations move towards real-time and AI-driven systems, Apache Paimon provides a solid foundation for building scalable, maintainable, and open data architectures. 

By: Vikas Awasthy

The author is a Bengaluru-based consultant data engineer with 12+ years of experience in designing and delivering enterprise-scale data solutions. His areas of interest include data lakehouses, cloud-native analytics, open source data technologies, and real-time data processing.